



Tamnies River Beach

## Tamnies

Chill out at the river beach in **Tamnies** which has rafts to swim out to, slides, tennis court, boules and kiosk which sells coffee and ice-cream. A life guard is on duty in the season. There are plenty of picnic tables available.

From Pechboutier take the road to Les Eyzies, turn right at the top away from Les Eyzies. Carry on this road for about 1.5kms. Further on your left you will see the sign for Tamnies. Follow all the signs for Tamnies or Etang de Tamnies. Stay on this road and do not turn up to Tamnies village itself. The river beach is on your right and cannot be missed. Price of entry is about a Euro per person.

## Château de Castelnaud & Gardens of Marqueyssac

Get a twin ticket for these two. The castle is interesting, with examples of armour and armory – especially the medieval catapults. You get a real sense of how it was to live in these times with videos and live demonstrations of iron work.



Chateau de Castelnaud



Gardens of Marqueyssac

Then visit the gardens which are located on top of a plateau. The views overlooking the Dordogne are breathtaking and there is an electric car which picks you up at the far end of the plateau if you have walked enough! In July and August the gardens are open every Thursday evening from 7pm until midnight and are lit by little night lights. Well worth a visit.

## Rocamadour & Gouffe de Padirac



Rocamadour



Gouffe de Padirac

**Rocamadour** is about an hour and a half away. It is well worth combining a visit with the best caves of the area. An historic shrine perched on a limestone cliff, Rocamadour tells a story of religious belief and human endeavor. Looking out over the gorge of the River Alzou, this city, devoted to the Virgin Mary has remained for over nine hundred years a symbol of faith and hope. If you wish to eat, stop at the café located on the main street at the bottom of the steps that lead up to the church, it has toys on the tables but I can't remember the name!

The **Gouffe de Padirac** is a natural, 75 meter chasm that shows on the limestone plateau of the "Causse de Gramat" in the Lot, below which, at 103 meters underground, flows a river. On descending 103 meters to reach the underground river, take either the lift or the stairs, you are at the start of a mystery voyage 500 meters long. Open from April.

